

BRAND AWARENESS AND RECOGNITION OF RAMBAN AMONG FARMERS

A project report submitted by

UMANG KUMAR SHYAM

(PGDM-ABM-2157)

In partial fulfilment for the award of



management
(sent)

Dr. R. V. ...



भाक अनुप - राष्ट्रीय कृषि अनुसंधान प्रबंध अकादमी

ICAR-NATIONAL ACADEMY OF AGRICULTURAL RESEARCH MANAGEMENT

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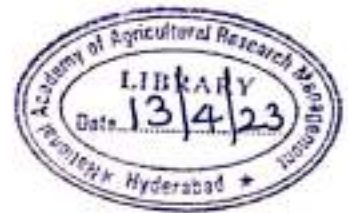
RAJENDRANAGA, HYDERABAD-500030

TELANGANA INDIA



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in partial fulfilment for the award of

**Post Graduate Diploma in Management
(Agribusiness Management)**

under the guidance of

Dr. R. V. S. RAO

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TELANGANA, INDIA

BONAFIDE CERTIFICATE

Certified that this project report ***“Brand awareness and Recognition of RAMBAN among farmers”*** is the bonafide work of ***“Umang Kumar Shyam”*** who carried out the project work under my guidance.

SIGNATURE
R. V. Satyanarayana Rao

Dr. R. V. S. RAO

Academic Guide

ICAR-NAARM

Umang Shyam
Umang Kumar Shyam

ICAR-NAARM

ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

I have immense pleasure in the successful completion of my project entitled, "*Brand awareness and Recognition of RAMBAN among farmers*". On this occasion, I would like to offer my sincerest gratitude to the personalities whose cooperation and valuable guidance was received during the project work.

I take this opportunity to express our sincere and deepest gratitude to "**Jubilant Agri & Consumer Products Ltd. (JACPL)**" for providing me a chance of learning through this internship. The project really helped me to have a deep insight of Fertilizer Sector in India.

I owe a great deal to **ICAR-NAARM** for laying the building blocks of logic and pragmatism in my life. This report, in a way is a reflection of these values.

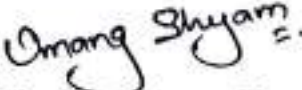
I'd like to extend my words of gratitude to my mentor **Dr. R.V.S. Rao** for consistently mentoring me. I thank him his inspiring and affectionate guidance, unending benevolence and constant encouragement during this final project.

I feel my immense pleasure in expressing my sincere and profound sense of gratitude especially to, **Mrs. Prerana Verma** (Product Manager, JACPL) and I would also like to thank **Mr. Gaurav Kumar** (Sr. ASM, JACPL) for their inspiring and affectionate guidance, unending benevolence, and constant encouragement during this project.

I bow my head in front of almighty and my parents who have always been the torch bearer for me throughout my work, by showing me the right path and boosting my moral to bring the best out of me.

I'd also like to thanks all the Farmers for spending their valuable time for giving authentic information to complete this project.

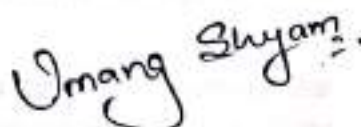
Last but not the least, I would like to thank my friends and colleagues whose support, guidance and insights have helped me in completing the project.


Umang Kumar Shyam
ICAR-NAARM

DECLARATION

Date: 10/04/2023

This is to declare that I, **Umang Kumar Shyam**, a student of Post Graduate Diploma Programme in Management (Agri-Business Management) (20221-2023), ICAR-NAARM have given original data, information and maintained full confidentiality to the best of my knowledge in the project report titled ***"Brand awareness and Recognition of RAMBAN among farmers"*** and that, no part of this information has been used for any other assignment but for the partial fulfilment of the requirements towards the completion of the said project.


Umang Kumar Shyam

(ICAR-NAARM)

ABSTRACT

The project titled ***"Brand awareness and Recognition of RAMBAN among farmers"*** is designed to assess the level of awareness and recognition of the single super phosphate (SSP) brand "RAMBAN" among farmers in a specific region. The project is initiated by the company that produces and markets the RAMBAN brand, with the objective of understanding how well the brand is known and perceived by farmers.

To achieve the objective, the project involves collecting data from a sample of farmers through a survey questionnaire. The survey questionnaire is designed to capture information related to the farmers' awareness and recognition of the RAMBAN brand, their usage patterns, and their overall satisfaction with the product. The survey questionnaire is designed to be easy to understand and take, and will be conducted in a manner that is non-intrusive and convenient for the farmers.

The survey questionnaire is administered to a sample of farmers randomly selected from the target population. The sample size will be determined based on statistical principles to ensure that the data collected is representative of the entire population. The survey data is collected using appropriate methods, such as face-to-face interviews, online surveys, or phone interviews, depending on the preferences of the farmers.

The data collected from the survey is analyzed using appropriate statistical tools to determine the level of awareness and recognition of the RAMBAN brand among farmers. The analysis includes measures such as brand recall, brand recognition, and brand loyalty, and will be conducted in a manner that is statistically sound and valid.

Based on the findings of the study, the company will develop strategies to increase the visibility and recognition of the RAMBAN brand among farmers. The strategies could include improving the packaging and labeling of the product, increasing promotional activities, enhancing the distribution network, or improving the quality and consistency of the product. The aim of these strategies will be to increase the market share of the RAMBAN brand and improve the profitability of the company.

In conclusion, the project titled ***"Brand awareness and Recognition of RAMBAN among farmers"*** is an important initiative by the company to understand how well the RAMBAN brand is known and perceived by farmers. The project is expected to provide valuable insights that will help the company to develop effective marketing and distribution strategies for the brand, and ultimately increase its market share and profitability.

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SSP is a commonly used fertilizer in agriculture because it is highly effective at supplying plants with phosphorus, which is an essential nutrient for growth and development. Phosphorus is involved in a range of processes, including photosynthesis, respiration, energy storage and transfer, and the formation of DNA and other important molecules.

SSP typically has a phosphorus content of around 16-20%, which makes it a good source of this nutrient for crops. It is also relatively inexpensive compared to other phosphorus fertilizers, making it a popular choice for farmers in many parts of the world.

However, SSP does have some disadvantages. It is highly acidic, which can be damaging to soil and plants if it is over-applied. It also contains relatively low levels of nitrogen and other nutrients, which may limit its effectiveness in certain soil types or crop systems. Overall, SSP is a useful fertilizer for many farmers, but it should be used carefully and in combination with other nutrients to ensure optimal crop yields and soil health.

Through this project, we hope to provide valuable insights to RAMBAN and other fertilizer brands to better understand the needs and preferences of farmers. The findings of this study will be useful for farmers as well, as it will help them to make informed decisions while selecting fertilizers for their farming practices.

Overall, this project report is expected to contribute towards the growth and development of the agricultural sector in India by enabling fertilizer brands to develop and market products that cater to the needs of farmers and increase their crop yields.

2 Review of literature

1 Introduction:

The agricultural sector plays a crucial role in the economy of India. To cater to the increasing demand for food production, farmers are adopting modern agricultural practices and using innovative fertilizers to increase their crop yields. One such fertilizer brand that has gained popularity in recent years is RAMBAN, which provides a range of Single Super Phosphate (SSP) products to farmers.

The objective of this project report is to analyse the level of brand awareness and recognition of RAMBAN as a fertilizer brand among farmers in India. The report aims to understand the level of brand recognition and awareness of RAMBAN and identify the factors that influence the farmers' decision-making process while selecting fertilizers for their crops.

Single Super Phosphate (SSP) is a type of fertilizer that is produced by treating phosphate rock with sulfuric acid. The resulting product is a mixture of monocalcium phosphate and gypsum (calcium sulfate).

SSP is a commonly used fertilizer in agriculture because it is highly effective at supplying plants with phosphorus, which is an essential nutrient for growth and development. Phosphorus is involved in a range of processes, including photosynthesis, respiration, energy storage and transfer, and the formation of DNA and other important molecules.

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2 Review of literatures



Literature studies help to understand the current situation & challenges; it also helps to identify gaps in the system. Keeping in view objective of the study, this will provide a brief review of the relevant studies done in past.

- **"Single Super Phosphate (SSP) fertilizers in agriculture: A review"** by A. Garg and S. Lal: This literature provides an overview of SSP fertilizers and their use in agriculture. The authors discuss the production process of SSP, its nutrient content, and its advantages and disadvantages compared to other fertilizers. It also covers the application rates and methods of SSP, and the effects of SSP on crop yields and soil health.
- **"Single Super Phosphate (SSP) Fertilizer Production and Use in Developing Countries"** by M. Anwar and A. Rauf: This literature focuses on the production and use of SSP in developing countries. The authors discuss the challenges and opportunities associated with SSP production and use in these countries, including issues related to technology, quality control, and marketing. It also covers the potential benefits of SSP for smallholder farmers in developing countries.
- **"Phosphorus fertilizer production and technology: An overview"** by S. Mukhopadhyay and S. Maiti: This literature review provides an overview of phosphorus fertilizer production and technology, including SSP. The authors discuss the different types of phosphorus fertilizers, their production processes, and their chemical properties. The review also covers the factors that influence the efficiency of phosphorus fertilizers, such as soil pH, organic matter content, and moisture.
- **"Single Superphosphate (SSP) fertilizers: a review"** by T. A. Jat et al.: This literature review provides an overview of SSP fertilizers, their production process, and their impact on crop yields and soil health. The authors discuss the different types of SSP fertilizers, their nutrient content, and their application rates and methods. The review also covers the potential benefits of SSP for soil fertility and plant growth, as well as the challenges associated with their production and use.
- **"Single superphosphate fertilizers: A critical review"** by R. Ali et al.: This literature review critically evaluates the use of SSP fertilizers in agriculture, including their impact on soil and plant health, as well as their economic and environmental implications. The authors discuss the benefits and limitations of SSP compared to other phosphorus fertilizers, and the challenges associated with their production and use. The review also covers the potential risks of excessive use of SSP fertilizers, such as soil acidification and eutrophication.

3 Deliverables

3.1 OBJECTIVES:

1. To understanding the brand recognition of RAMBAN.
2. To access the brand awareness of JACPL and RAMBAN.
3. To identify the factors influencing RAMBAN buying decision.
4. To analyze the scope for other products to be included in RAMBAN portfolio.

3.2 EXPECTED OUTCOMES:

1. To calculate awareness level of RAMBAN among farmers.
2. To find out alternative product and the differentiating factors.
3. To find a micronutrient product to be included in portfolio.

4 Research Methodology

4.1 Type of Research

Exploratory research

Number of farmers

4.2 Source of data

Primary data collection

11

4.3 Tools for data collection

12

Structured Questionnaire / Schedule

19

4.4 Sampling method

Simple Random Sampling

59

4.5 Approach

14

One-on-One Interviews

10

4.6 Type of analysis

Descriptive analysis

11

11

4.7 Analysis software

MS-Excel, Power BI

12

4.8 Sample Size

131

Total number of villages covered – 75

Total number of Farmers surveyed - 1052

4.8.1 Farmers sample size Village – wise (District - Pilibhit, Uttar Pradesh)

Name of Village	Number of farmers
Adwada	11
Amir nagar	12
Amkhera	19
Atanga Chandpur	10
Auria	14
Badhepura	10
Bahadurpur	11
Barbhiau	11
Bargachha	12
Barkhera	31

Basha gawalpur	12
Bhainsaha	11
Bhamaura	10
Bhandariya	38
Bithoura Khurd	10
Bithra	13
Chanduiya	7
Dadhiya Lachhi	18
Daulatpur	9
Gazipur kundya	28
Gularhai	11
Gulariya	19
Gulra	8

Hasimpur	6
Imaliya	12
Jadpur patti	8
Jagipur	14
Janak Puri	8
Jyohara	13
Kajargojhi	12
Kalliya	23
Kathaliyaa	6
Khagai	8
Khargapur	8
Kishanpur	6
Kokli	24

Kuraia	12
Laulikhera	1
Lucknow Kala	8
Maichhana	10
Mandaria	18
Masit	30
Muriya kudri	8
Musharha	13
Nakta	16
Narayanpur	6
Nawada	14
Nawaha	8
Neoria	18

Painiya	8
Pandri	11
Pathrasa	6
Patrasa	17
Penha	6
Piparia Total	14
Piparia mandan	21
Pipra	6
Pipra khaas	8
Pratapdadhi	8
Rajacolony	15
Rampura	10
Rampura natthu	11

Rampuriya	12
Sandiya	6
Shivpuriya	10
Sitahura	11
Varmik	14
Grand Total	839

Table 1. Farmers sample size Village – wise (District - Pilibhit, Uttar Pradesh)

4.8.2 Farmers sample size Village-wise (District – Udham Singh Nagar, Uttarakhand)

Name of Village	Number of farmers
Banusi	21
Charu Beta	38
Khatima	32
Kuwan Khera	43
Majhola	16

Mundeli	12
Radhuliya	31
Ratanpur	20
Grand Total	213

Table 2. Farmers sample size Village-wise (District – Udham Singh Nagar, Uttarakhand)

Figure 2. Brand recognition of Ramban among farmers

Above 60% of farmers who, have, owned and used are able to recognize RAMBAN logo easily while only 10% were able to recognize Ramban logo.

5.1.2 Number of farmers familiar with Ramban as a company



Figure 1. Glimpses of data collection period

Figure 2. Number of farmers familiar with Ramban as a company

5 DATA INTERPRETATION

5.1 Brand recognition & awareness

5.1.1 Which brand logo are you familiar with?

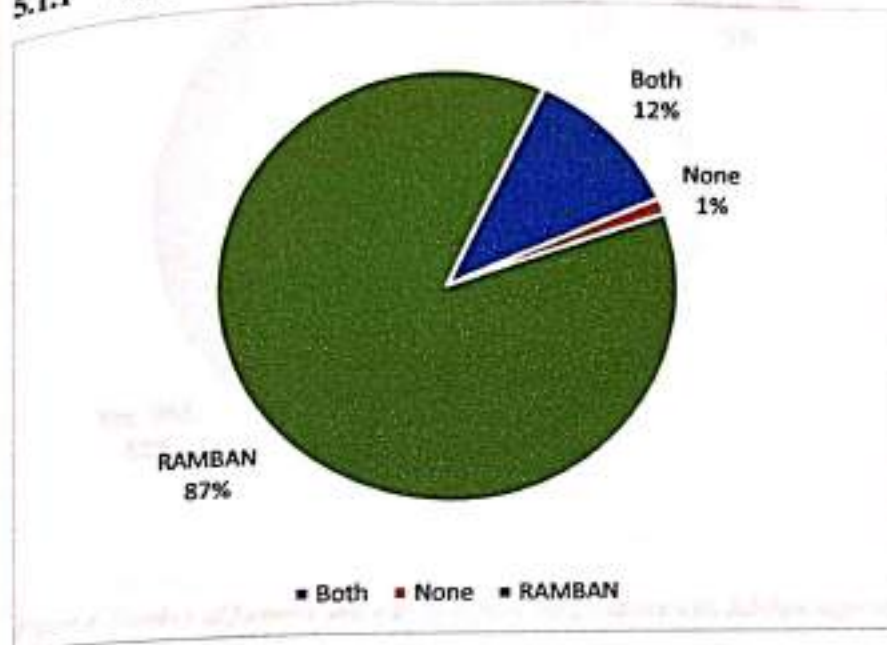


Figure 2. Which brand logo are you familiar with?

About 99% of farmers who have ever used SSP are able to recognize RAMBAN logo easily while only 12% were able to identify Jubilant logo.

5.1.2 Number of farmers familiar with Jubilant as a company

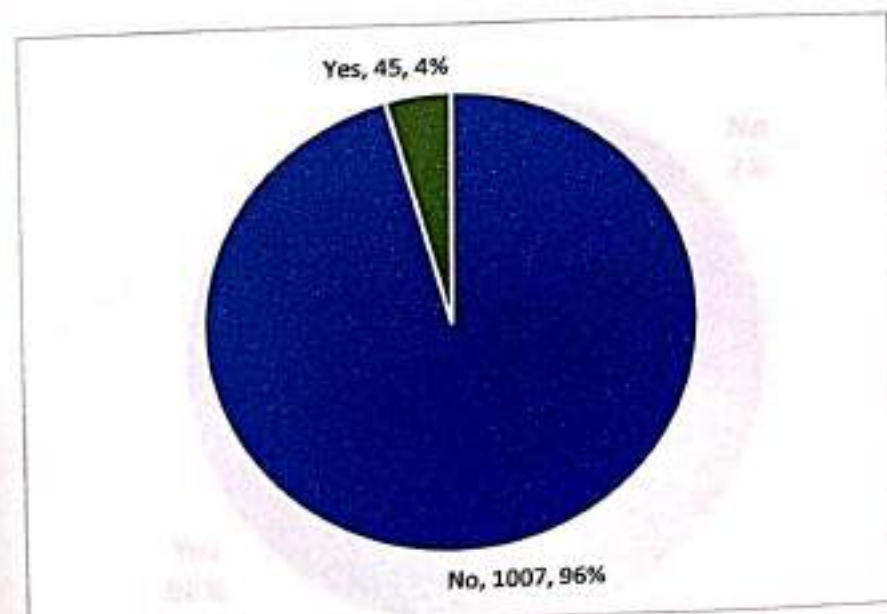


Figure 3. Number of farmers familiar with Jubilant as a company

5.1.3 Number of farmers who can recognise the products with Jubilant logo in future

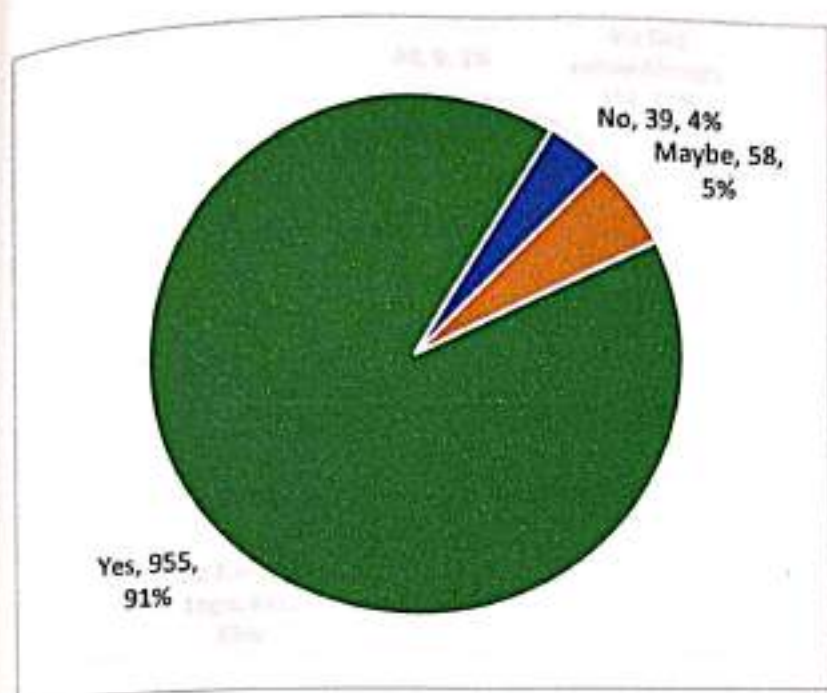


Figure 4. Number of farmers who can recognise the products with Jubilant logo in future

Although, only 45 out of 1052 (4%) farmers were able to recognize Jubilant as a company but 91% told that they can recognize Jubilant logo in future after being aware.

5.1.4 Farmers heard/used RAMBAN ever

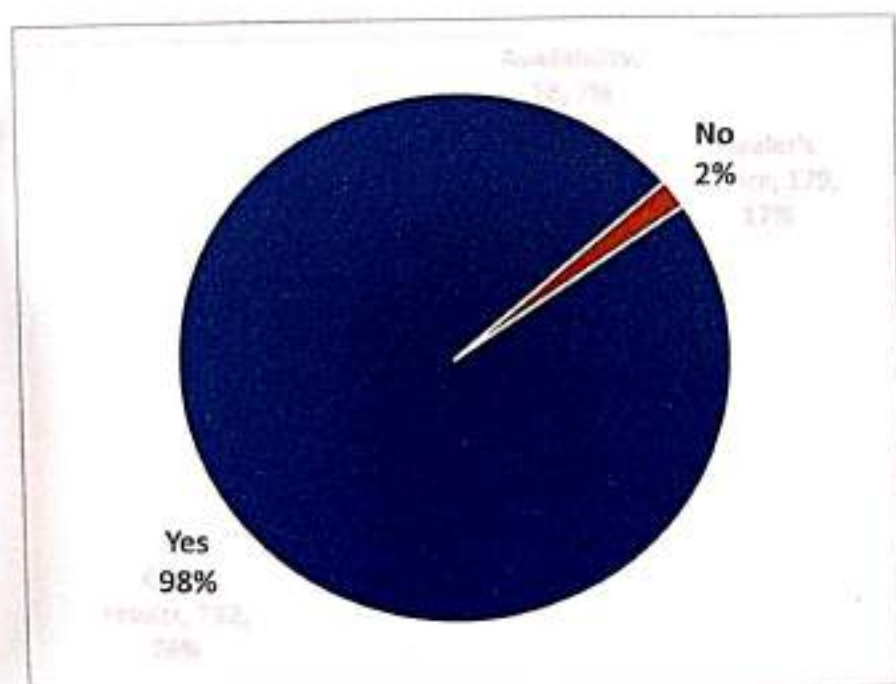


Figure 5. Farmers heard/used RAMBAN ever

5.1.5 Identification of right RAMBAN product

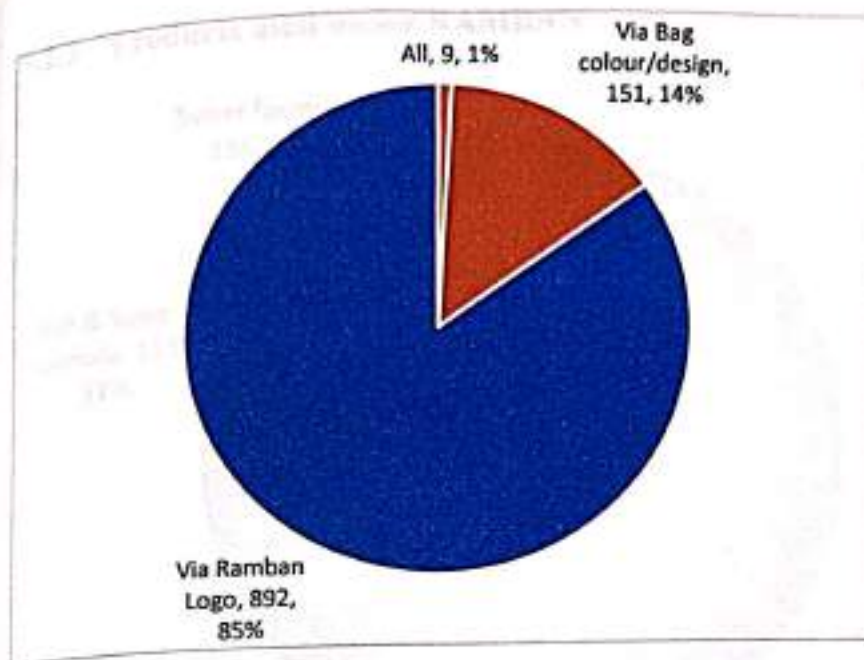


Figure 6. Identification of right RAMBAN product

Majority (85%) of farmers are looking at RAMBAN logo in order to identify correct bag.

5.2 Factors influencing purchase & Use

5.2.1 Factors influencing purchase

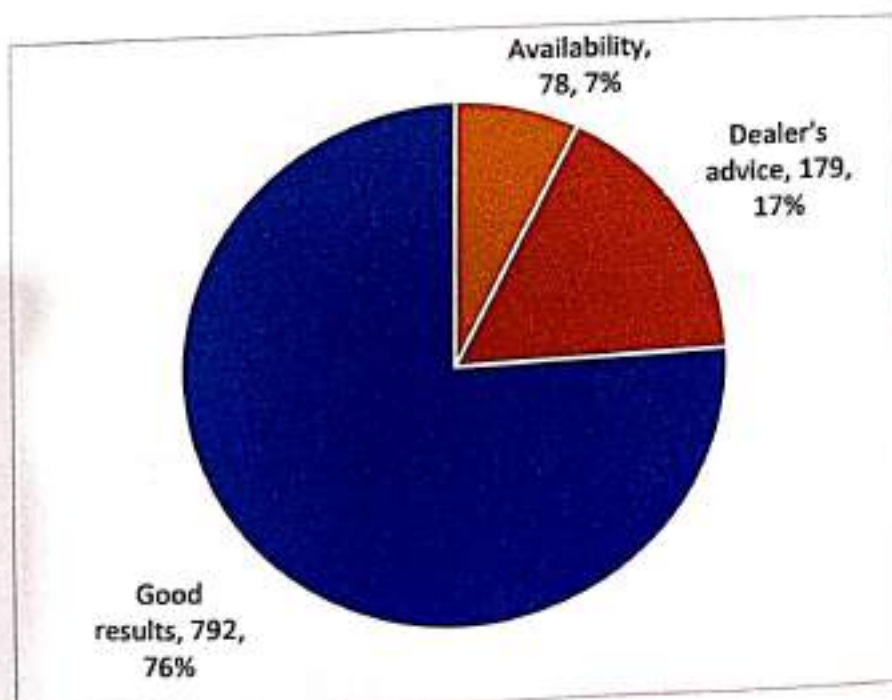


Figure 7. Factors influencing purchase

Good results on field is major driving force for sales of RAMBAN products.

5.2.2 Products used under RAMBAN

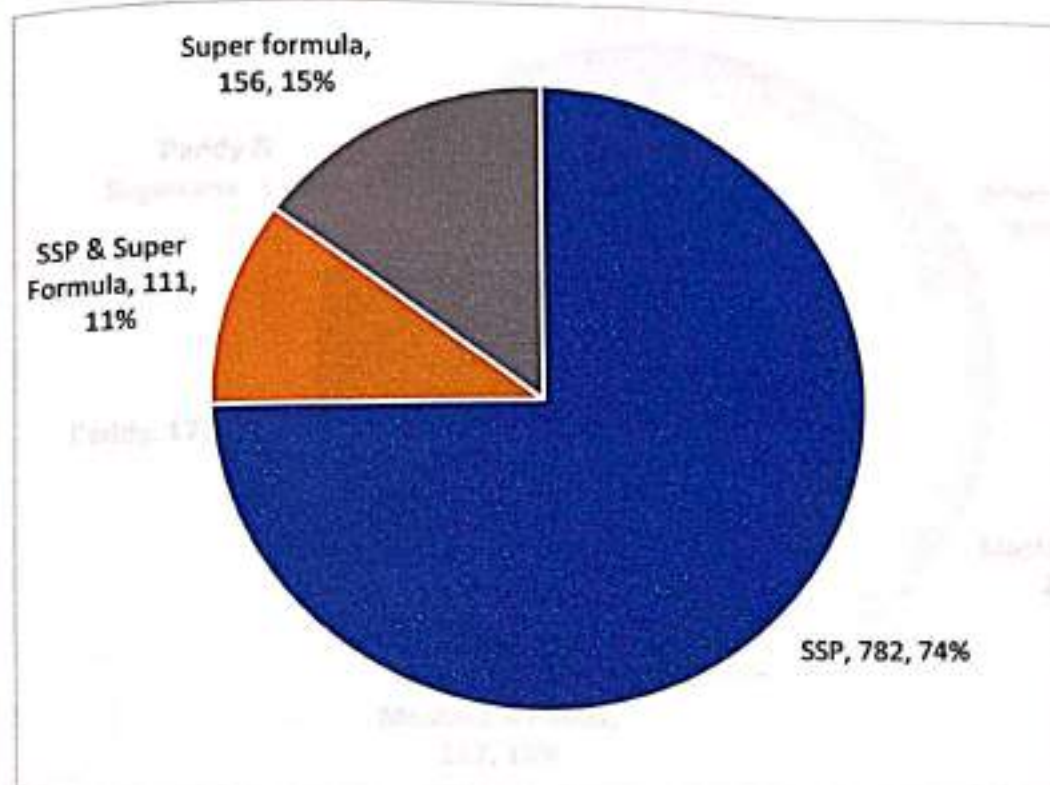


Figure 8. Products used under RAMBAN

SSP is the major product sold under RAMBAN brand.



Figure 10. Distribution of Super Formula

5.2.3 Destination of SSP

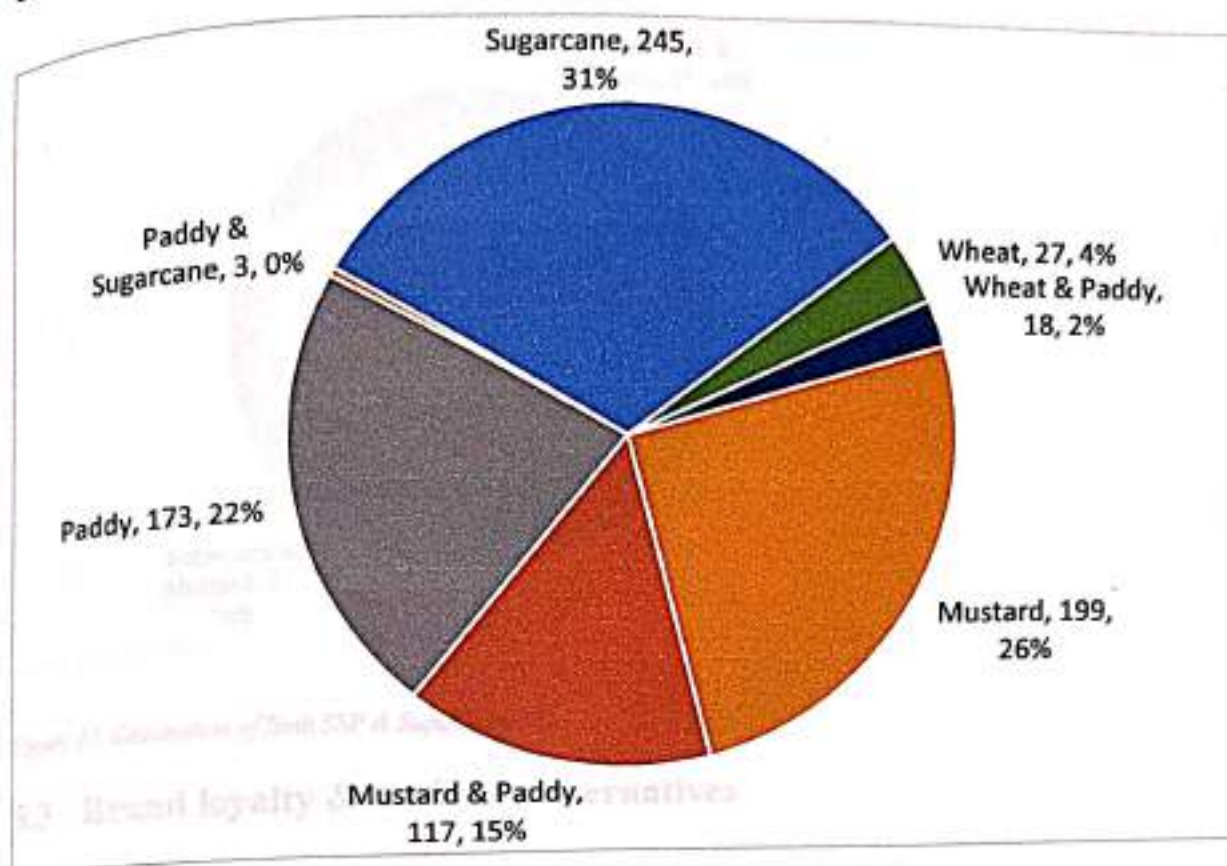


Figure 9. Destination of SSP

5.2.4 Destination of Super Formula

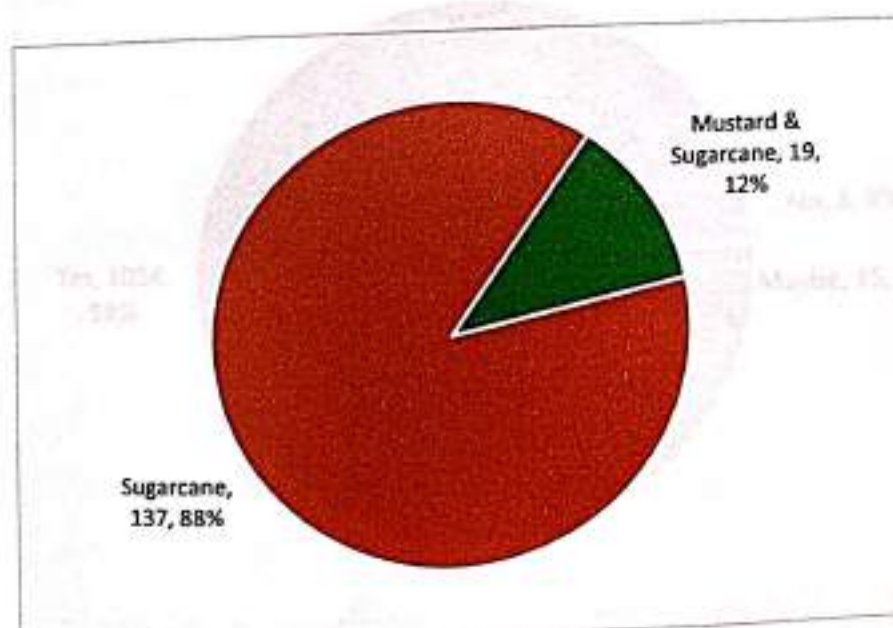


Figure 10. Destination of Super Formula

5.2.5 Destination of Both SSP & Super Formula

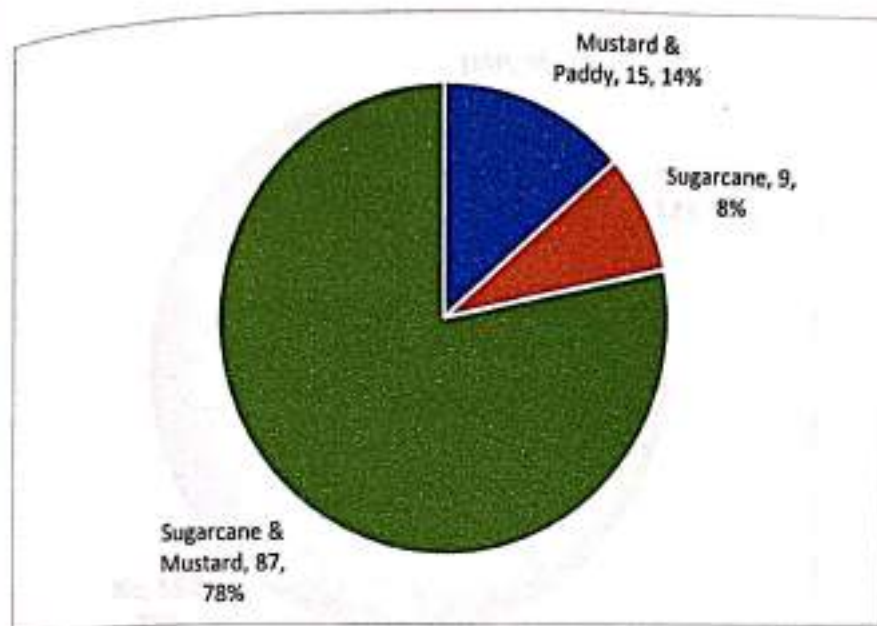


Figure 11. Destination of Both SSP & Super Formula

5.3 Brand loyalty & available alternatives

5.3.1 Will they buy / recommend other RAMBAN products? 18% see Gramin Super Formula as a potential alternative.

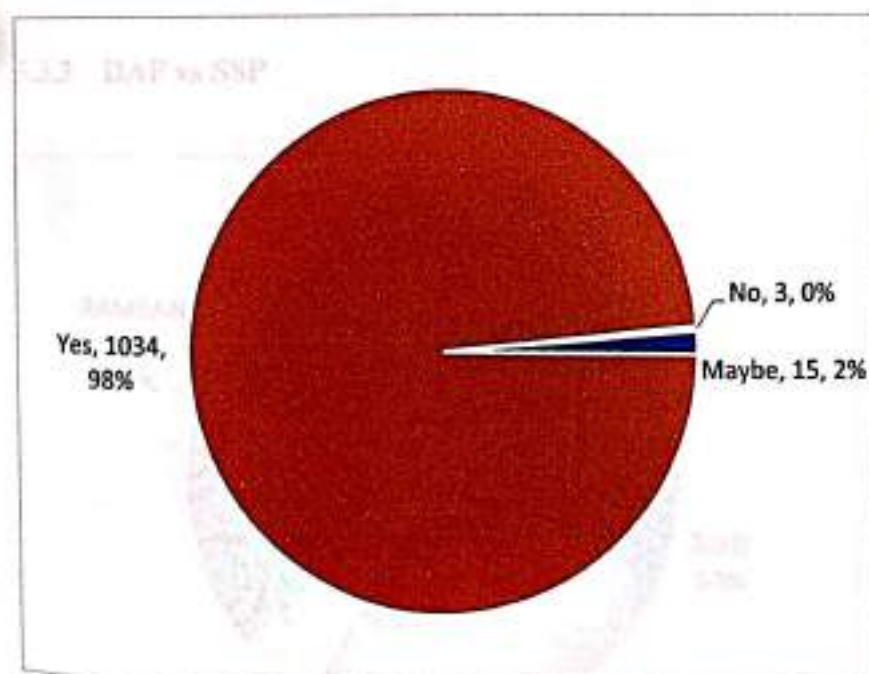


Figure 12. Will they buy / recommend other RAMBAN products?

98% farmers trust the brand and willing to use & recommend in future as well.

5.3.2 Available alternatives

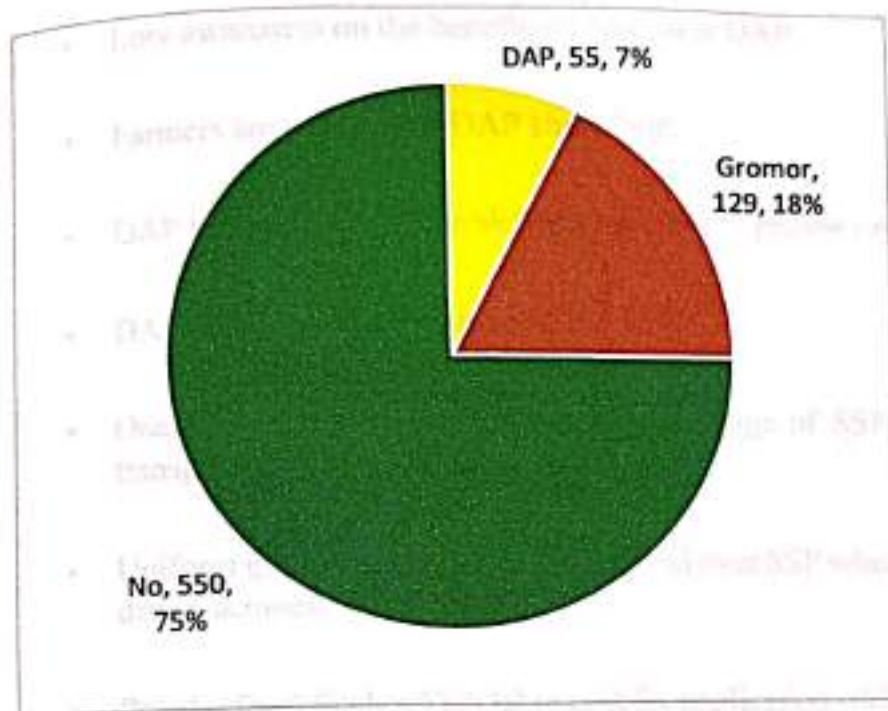


Figure 13. Available alternatives of Ramban

75% farmers feel there's no alternative for RAMBAN while 18% see Gromor from Coromandel as a potential alternative.

5.3.3 DAP vs SSP

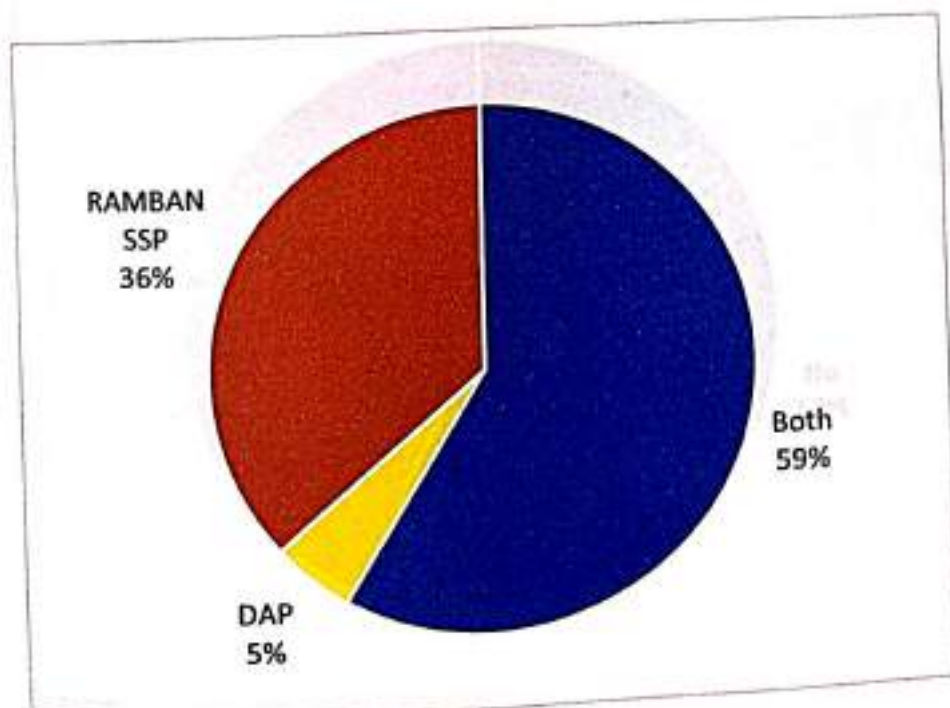


Figure 14. DAP vs SSP

5.3.4 Reasons for preferring DAP over SSP

- Low awareness on the benefits of SSP over DAP.
- Farmers are used to use DAP since long.
- DAP has nitrogen in it, which allows them to reduce / escape the use of urea.
- DAP is slightly cheaper than SSP.
- One bag of DAP is equivalent to three bags of SSP, Which adds extra labor and transportation cost.
- Uniform granule size of DAP is preferred over SSP when applied by seed-cum-fertilizer drill machines.
- Powder form fetches high labor cost for application while granules take time to dissolve in the field.

5.4 Scope for other micro-nutrient products

5.4.1 Do they want any new micronutrient combination?

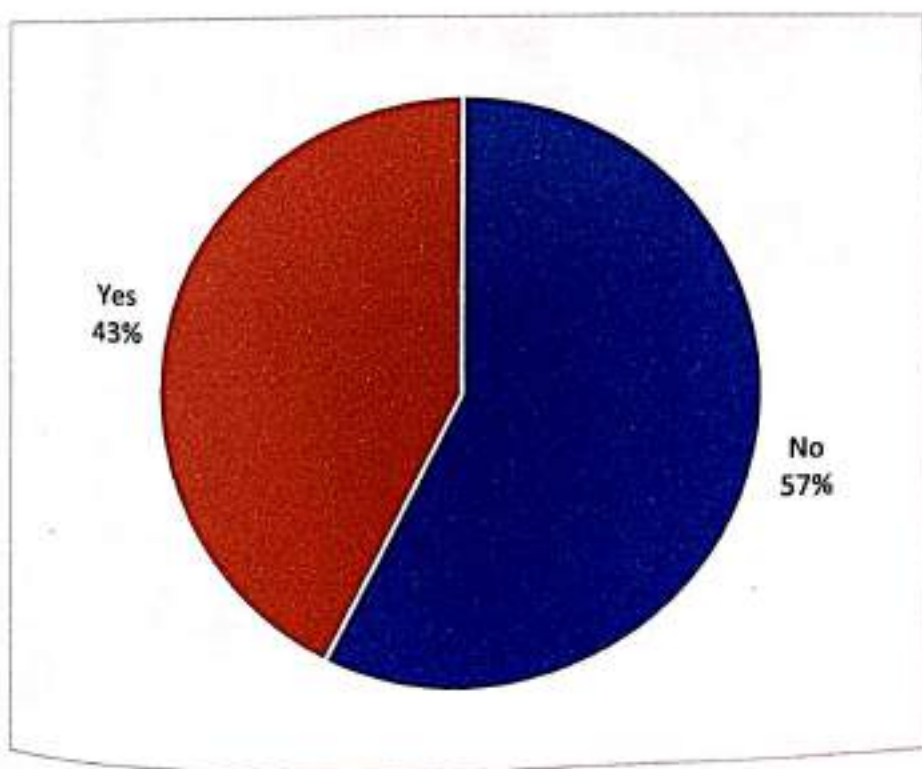


Figure 15. Do they want any new micronutrient combination?

5.4.2 Potential scope for other products

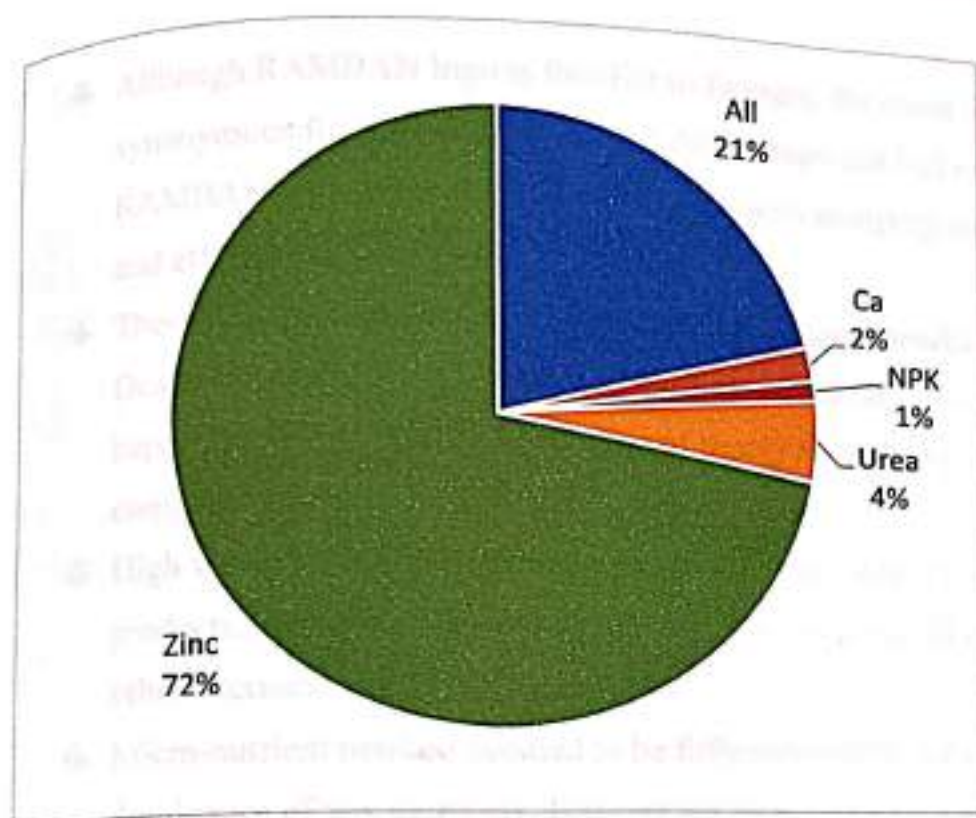


Figure 16. Potential scope for other products

Note: This result may not give an accurate idea of micro-nutrient products as farmers have a little awareness on this.

6 Key Findings / Observations

- ✦ Although RAMBAN logo is familiar to farmers, the name “RAMBAN” has become synonymous for SSP in most areas. Jubilant logo can be branded for replacing RAMBAN logo but replacing brand name with company name will take much time and efforts.
- ✦ There's an excellent customer retention due to good results of product. However, Dealer's/Retailer's advice found to be a major driving force for sales. Dealers are happily pushing RAMBAN because of timely availability and good support from company.
- ✦ High value crops like Sugarcane and Mustard are major destination of SSP and other products. Farmers growing crops like Wheat purchases SSP usually in absence of other alternatives like NPK and DAP.
- ✦ Micro-nutrient markets seemed to be fully controlled by dealers. There's no visible dominance of any company. Farmers are least aware to identify/decide any of such products.



Figure 17. Glimpses of data collection period

Figure 18. Glimpses of data collection period

7 Recommendations

7.1 Brand Awareness Campaign

Extensive effort is needed to be made in order to aware farmers about Jubilant Logo and Name. JACPL may be redesigned consisting the element of RAMBAN logo in order to be more effective.

7.2 Field Demonstration & Customer loyalty Program

Proper methods of application of SSP must be demonstrated along with highlighting benefits of SSP over DAP. Customer loyalty programs (distributing cash rewards and other gifts to farmers) can attract more farmers to shift from DAP to SSP.

7.3 Crop-specific micro-nutrient mixture

Company can come up with a new product consisting all micro-nutrients needed for particular crops in right amount. It can be started with high value crops like Sugarcane.

8 Bibliography

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9 Learnings

9.1 Understanding of sales process

Working with on-field team of Jubilant gave an understanding about sales process, stakeholders involved, challenges etc. The project enriched with rich experience of on field challenges and ways to tackle them.

9.2 Understanding of the industry

Doing a competitor's analysis for Ramban gave a wider understanding of various stakeholders involved in Fertilizer industry. The project helped me in gaining a thorough understanding of fertilizer industry and SSP industry in particular.

9.3 Understanding of farmers perception about micro-nutrients'

The project helped in gaining a thorough knowledge about farmers' perception regarding micro-nutrient fertilizers. I understood the misconception spread among farmers about it.

ANNEXURE

QUESTIONNAIRE FOR FARMERS

1. Basic Details of Farmers

Name	
Mobile No.	
Area under cultivation	
Village	
Mandal/Block	
District	
State	

2. Educational Qualification

- ☐ Uneducated
- ☐ Primary
- ☐ Secondary
- ☐ Graduate & above

3. Is any of the following logo familiar to you?

- ☐ Jubilant
- ☐ RAMBAN
- ☐ Both

- None
4. Do you know Jubilant as a company?
- Yes
- No
5. If yes, do you know/use any of Jubilant product?
- Yes
- No
6. Name (If remember) _____.
7. Have you ever heard of/used RAMBAN?
- Yes
- No
8. Which RAMBAN product you've used?
- _____.
9. How do you identify the correct RAMBAN product while buying?
- Via Jubilant Logo
- Via Ramban Logo
- Via Bag colour/design
- All
- Other _____.
10. On which crops do you use RAMBAN product?
- a. _____.
- b. _____.
- c. _____.
11. Why do you use RAMBAN products? -
- _____.

12. Will you buy other products of RAMBAN?

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No

13. Will you recommend RAMBAN to other farmers?

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No

14. Whether you use RAMBAN SSP or DAP?

15. Why do you prefer DAP over SSP?

16. What is the available alternative for RAMBAN?

17. Differentiating factors for alternative brand.

- a. _____
- b. _____
- c. _____

18. Do you want any other (micro-nutrient) combination from RAMBAN?

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No

19. If Yes, Suggest a few combinations.

- a. _____
- b. _____
- c. _____